

Shafique Islam

Ph.D. Student, Department of Economics, University of Pittsburgh

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Research Interests

Labor Economics, Applied Microeconomics, Economics of Education, Public Economics, Development Economics, Immigration, Technological Change

Education

University of Pittsburgh	Pittsburgh, PA
Ph.D. in Economics	2023–Present
M.A. in Economics	
Central Michigan University	Mount Pleasant, MI
M.A. in Economics	2022
University of Dhaka	Dhaka, Bangladesh
M.S.S. in Economics	2015
B.S.S. in Economics	2014

Skills

Methods: Causal inference and applied econometrics: staggered difference-in-differences (Callaway–Sant’Anna), event studies, synthetic difference-in-differences, panel data and time-series methods.

Data: Large-scale public and administrative data: American Community Survey, IPEDS, County Business Patterns, IRS migration data, Lightcast job postings; data cleaning, linkage, and visualization.

Software: R, Stata, SAS 9.4 (Base Programming), Tableau, L^AT_EX, Git/GitHub.

Working Papers

Warehouses and Diplomas: Amazon’s Expansion and Local Educational Attainment [\[PDF\]](#)

Best Second-Year Paper Award, Department of Economics, University of Pittsburgh, 2026

- Estimates the effect of Amazon’s logistics facility rollout on local human capital, exploiting the staggered timing of Amazon’s entry into U.S. commuting zones between 2010 and 2024.
- Finds that Amazon’s entry raised educational attainment, particularly bachelor’s and master’s degrees; more graduates moved to or stayed in treated areas, and students shifted from part-time to full-time enrollment.
- Shows that the effects reflect spillovers: Amazon’s presence expanded skilled employment at other firms and raised local demand for college graduates.

When Samples Shape Significance [\[PDF\]](#)

with Sonia Ale, Lester Lusher, Huda Osman, and Jacob Stenstrom

- Replicates findings from 24 papers in top economics journals and re-estimates each result across 40 independent resamples drawn from the same data-generating process.
- Shows that sampling variation alone can overturn statistical significance even when the research design is held fixed.

Work in Progress

Opportunity or Trap? First Jobs and Immigrant Integration in the U.S. (with Gabrielle Toborg)
AI Adoption and the Gender Wage Gap

Awards and Fellowships

Social Sciences Doctoral Dissertation (SSDD) Fellowship, University of Pittsburgh	2026–2027
Best Second-Year Paper Award, Department of Economics, University of Pittsburgh	2026
Arts and Sciences Graduate Fellowship, University of Pittsburgh	2024–2025
Governor Award, Department of Economics, University of Dhaka	2014
Government Scholarship, Bangladesh	2010

Research Experience

Graduate Research Assistant to Professor Bharati Basu Aug 2022–May 2023

Department of Economics, Central Michigan University

Principal Investigator, Research Grant BDT 30,000

Research Cell, Noakhali Science and Technology University: “The Nexus Between Economic Policy Uncertainty and Exchange Rate Volatility: Empirical Evidence from Ireland”

Co-Principal Investigator, Research Grant BDT 70,000

Research Cell, Noakhali Science and Technology University: “Foreign Direct Investment in the Ready-Made Garment Industry in Bangladesh”

Thesis and Project Supervision 2017–2020

Noakhali Science and Technology University

- Supervised two M.A. theses: Habiba Sultana, “The Nexus Between Economic Policy Uncertainty and Exchange Rate Volatility: Empirical Evidence from Ireland” (2019); Mohammad Raselar Rahman, “The Effect of Monetary Policy on Stock Market Performances: Evidence from SAARC Selected Countries” (2020).
- Supervised five undergraduate research projects.

Teaching Experience

Graduate Teaching Assistant 2024–2026

University of Pittsburgh. Introduction to Microeconomics (Fall 2024, Spring 2025, Fall 2025); Introduction to Macroeconomics (Spring 2026).

Graduate Teaching Assistant Jan 2021–May 2022

Central Michigan University

Assistant Professor of Economics Nov 2017–Jan 2021

Noakhali Science and Technology University. Advanced Macroeconomics, International Trade, Public Finance.

Lecturer in Economics Nov 2015–Nov 2017

Noakhali Science and Technology University. Econometrics, Intermediate Microeconomics, Intermediate Macroeconomics, Dynamic Optimization, Mathematics for Economists, Statistical Methods, Statistical Inference, Monetary Economics.

Pre-Ph.D. Publications

- Ale, S. A., & Islam, S. (2022). A panel data analysis of infrastructure, human capital development, and economic growth: Evidence from ten newly industrialized countries. *American Journal of Economics and Business Management*, 5(8), 177–185.
- Ale, S. A., & Islam, S. (2022). Does external debt affect economic growth? Evidence from South Asian countries. *International Journal of Economics and Financial Issues*.
- Rahman, M. R., Selim, M. M. I., Haque, A. U., Smrity, D. Y., & Islam, S. (2019). Examining the effect of exchange rate and overseas employment on remittances: Evidence from Bangladesh. *Theoretical Economics Letters*, 9, 2593–2605.
- Sultana, H., Islam, S., Haque, A. U., & Ale, S. A. (2019). Income inequality and economic growth: Empirical evidence from Bangladesh. *Journal of Economics and Sustainable Development*, 10(16), 78–83.
- Ale, S. A., Akter, R., & Islam, S. (2018). Remittance inflow and GDP growth: Evidence from Bangladesh, India, and Pakistan. *Asian Economic and Financial Review*, 8(11), 1340–1353.
- Hossain, S., Kibria, G., & Islam, S. (2018). Does globalization affect the economic growth of Bangladesh? An econometric analysis. *Asian Economic and Financial Review*, 8(12), 1384–1393.
- Ale, S. A., & Islam, S. (2017). Do the exchange rates of freely floating exchange rate regimes exhibit mean reversion? *Journal of Economics and Sustainable Development*, 8(20), 81–84.
- Islam, S., & Ale, S. A. (2017). Examining the effect of expenditure-changing and expenditure-switching policies on real GDP in Bangladesh. *Journal of Noakhali Science and Technology University*, 1(2), 67–72.

Service and Leadership

Noakhali Science and Technology University

Course Coordinator, Department of Economics

Jan 2017–Jan 2021

Assistant Provost, Abdus Salam Hall

Dec 2015–Jan 2021

Adviser, Royal Economics Club

Oct 2018–Jan 2021

Sports and Cultural Secretary, Teachers Association

2018

University of Dhaka

General Member, Economics Study Center, Department of Economics

Professional Training

Training in Teaching Methods and Techniques

Bangladesh Agricultural University

One-month program at the Graduate Training Institute, sponsored by the World Bank and the University Grants Commission of Bangladesh.

Memberships and References

Member, American Economic Association; Bangladesh Economic Association (2015–Present). References available upon request.

Last updated: October 2026